
1.4 Topic 2: Going Global

Globalisation

Globalisation and the links it creates is happening at an ever-increasing pace. Whilst some argue that it spreads wealth and power in beneficial ways, there is widespread concern about the way in which globalisation impacts on economies, societies and environments. Many researchers argue that it is creating an unfair world in which rich consumers exploit the world's poorest peoples, who remain unfairly or poorly connected to the wider world. Action to develop a more sustainable approach to these challenges is leading to difficult decisions at a variety of scales from the individual to global markets.

Population migration

One of globalisation's inevitable effects is that people are encouraged to move to escape from poverty or to take advantage of new opportunities. This escalating population migration (both within and between countries) is creating a new population dynamic. The rate of these changes is occurring at all scales, challenging individuals, communities and governments. Students will research the growth of megacities and migration relating to EU enlargement, as well as undertaking a brief personal demographic study linking their own roots with the wider global picture.

The consequences of going global are considerable but there needs to be a realisation that global agreements, green strategies and ethical purchases can modify the negative results of globalisation.

1 Globalisation

Enquiry question: *What is globalisation and how is it changing people's lives?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ The concept and development of globalisation (the connections between people and environments across the globe).	■ Exploring the concepts, processes and terminology relating to globalisation, population change and migration.
■ The factors which have accelerated globalisation.	■ Investigating the expansion of TNCs, international organisations and global markets.

■ The effects of globalisation on population movements.	■ Exploring the nature of the unprecedented numbers of voluntary/economic migrants. (This foundation work may be used as a starting point or incorporated into the teaching of this unit as required, depending upon the prior learning of students.)
---	--

2 Global groupings

Enquiry question: *What are the main groupings of nations and what differences in levels of power and wealth exist?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ The disparities in global wealth and poverty, through broad economic and political groupings of countries (such as NICs, OPEC, LEDCs, LDCs, OECD, and trade blocs like NAFTA).	■ Developing an awareness of the various ways of classifying nations into global groupings and how these change over time, in response to international trade agreements and changes in wealth and power.
■ TNCs play a crucial role in the development and spread of global business and trade.	■ Investigating the role of TNCs and their global significance, using a suitable case study.

3 Global networks

Enquiry question: *Why, as places and societies become more interconnected, do some places show extreme wealth and poverty?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ Global networks (such as air travel, TNCs, and tourism) create flows of trade, money, workers and information, which 'switch on' some places making them rich and powerful; while others may become 'switched off' and remain poor.	■ Investigating how examples of global networks create global patterns and can increase or decrease connectivity.
■ The role of technology (such as communications and the internet) in a shrinking world.	■ Researching the role of air travel, telecoms and the internet in promoting an interconnected world.
■ Why some places are 'winners' as significant producers and consumers, having valuable physical and human resources; whereas others are 'losers' remaining poorly connected.	■ Researching how natural resources, energy, labour pools, skills, and culture can be magnets for investment and influence global connectivity, allowing new Indian and Chinese companies to be 'winners' and parts of Africa 'losers'.

4 Roots

Enquiry question: *How does evidence from personal, local and national sources help us understand the pattern of population change in the UK?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ An analysis of population change (family size, population structure, migration, employment and social aspirations) using family histories or records.	■ Investigating by family tree/history or records how the local population has changed.
■ How social and economic factors such as 20th century changes in patterns of work and improvements in health, hygiene, nutrition and education have had an impact on UK population and migration.	■ Researching the depression, baby boom, decline of heavy industry, south east drift in the UK and the growth of consumerism.

■ The geographical challenges resulting from a greying population.	■ Researching the economic and social effects of an ageing population eg dependency, retirement, health and welfare provision.
--	--

5 On the move

Enquiry question: *How is migration changing the face of the EU?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ Key migrations into Europe at an international scale, contrasting recent and earlier (post-colonial) flows.	■ Developing an awareness of the cultural-economic linkages between European countries and the wider world.
■ Key movements within Europe include: ◆ a case study of post-accession labour flows from eastern Europe ◆ a case study of retirement flows to Mediterranean locations.	■ Researching and explaining movements of Polish and other workers to the UK, and Britons retiring to Spain.
■ The economic, social, environmental and political consequences of these movements and the issues and reactions they create.	■ Weighing up the consequences such as nationalism, culture, religion, citizenship and immigration policy/controls.

6 World cities

Enquiry question: *What is driving the new urbanisation taking place and what are its consequences?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ How rural-urban population migration feeds the growth of million and megacities.	■ Showing awareness of the causes and processes of rural to urban migration.

■ Megacities in differing countries develop in contrast ways, focusing on destinations for newcomers (shanty towns and inner city) and movers (suburbanisation).	■ Researching and appreciating the diversity of two megacities (cycle of urbanisation of one European and one Asian city).
■ The consequences of this new growth, especially in megacities and whether it can be sustained.	■ Thinking critically about cities of the future, especially in China and India, and whether sustainable urban living is achievable.

7 Global challenges for the future

Enquiry question: *What are the social and environmental consequences of globalisation and can we manage these changes for a better world?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ Globalisation brings both positive and negative changes ie a two-speed world.	■ Weighing up the positive and negative effects of mass purchasing of commodities, such as food miles, exporting jobs, packaging and worker exploitation, etc.
■ The moral and social consequences of globalisation, such as the exploitation of workers or cultures in some countries.	■ Thinking critically about whether the lives of rural to urban migrants are improved.
■ Reducing the environmental and social costs of globalisation requires action at a variety of scales from local (recycling/landfill etc) to global (carbon credit trading, etc).	■ Researching and weighing up the viability of conservation and green strategies and the difficult decisions individuals, societies, businesses and countries may have to take.
■ The viability of green strategies and ethical purchases to conserve and manage resources to create a more equitable world (such as buying locally or fair trading).	■ Developing an awareness that countries and individual consumers can have impacts on global poverty brought about by globalisation.